

week and work part time at a vintage clothing store over the weekends. She worked extremely hard that summer at all three jobs. The boost to her résumé has been priceless.

SEVEN TIPS ON INTERNSHIPS

Every summer, we attract a talented group of young men and women to intern at O’Leary Ventures. We run a compliant program, which means we’re school-approved. We give our interns a lot of mentorship and real-world experience, and we go to bat for them when they’re applying for jobs. They do great work, everything from due diligence to designing the packaging for *Shark Tank* deals.

This year, I sat down with Rebecca Fazio, Ramin Wright and James Laureys to get the “inside scoop” on our internship program. Rebecca is our marketing, branding and design intern. Ramin and James assist with due diligence on deals from *Dragons’ Den* and *Shark Tank*.

Here are some great tips from all three interns on how to showcase your talents so you stand out and have a better chance of getting full-time, gainful employment once your internship is over.

1. **Be persistent.** “Hiring interns is never at the top of a company’s priority list,” says Ramin, “so you need to make yourself stand out. When the president of O’Leary Ventures gave a talk at the University of Toronto, I made sure to introduce myself. After I applied for the internship, I sent him a short reminder email every Monday afternoon to keep my application on his mind.” Ramin is right—don’t be afraid to be bold.